

Forced Acts

Danny Boyle joins a hal-
lowed list of men and
women in Bollywood's
Coerced Adoption Hall
of Fame. Here's the lot:

Danny Boyle

How could India let him
forget that *Slumdog*



Millionaire saved his
career from heading
down the toilet?

M. Night Shyamalan

Born in Puducherry
but after *Sixth Sense*,
it's like he never left
for Philadelphia.

Norah Jones

Pandit Ravi Shankar
had christened her
Geetanjali, declaring it
to the world and India
after her first Grammy.

Gurinder Chaddha

After *Bend It Like
Beckham*, India forgot
about her Kenyan
origins and emphasised
her *Punjabiyat* instead.

Ben Kingsley

Pipped Naseeruddin
Shah to the role of
Gandhi, but far slower to
acknowledge he was
actually Krishna Bhanji.

DELHI | Helicopter Hullabaloo

What will incoming US
President Barack
Obama have in common
with President Pratibha
Patil? The helicopter that
transports them both is
likely to be the Franco-
British Augusta Westland
AW-101. But not if one US
helicopter firm, Sikorsky,
can help it. Sikorsky has sent a legal
notice to Defence Minister A.K. Antony
citing lack of transparency in the
contract for acquiring 12 VIP helicopters
worth an estimated Rs 4,000 crore. The
November 24 letter says the company
knew its S-92 chopper was rejected
nearly three months before an official
communication from the Ministry of
Defence (MOD). "We have asked for a fair



hearing," said Air Vice Marshal A.J.S.
Walia (retd) of Sikorsky. Technical evalu-
ations of the Westland's AW-101 and
Sikorsky's S-92 began in January 2008.
Competitor Augusta Westland says they
are unaware of the legal notice and that
they are on track with price negotiations
with the Indian MOD which will hopefully
culminate in a contract.

by Sandeep Unnithan

B.K.RAMESH



DELHI | Wi-Fi Tracks

The railways are planning to pro-
vide broadband connectivity to
all major long distance trains. While
a pilot project is already underway
on the Mumbai-Ahmedabad
Shatabdi Express and one on the
Chennai-Bangalore Shatabdi
Express will start soon. "Once the
trials are over and security issues
worked out to prevent misuse, we
will decide on the modalities," says
a railway official. by Nandini Vaish

200
trains are
expected to
provide an
on-board Wi-Fi
service in the
next five years.

BANGALORE | Not So Nice

H.D. Deve Gowda
has accused the
B.S. Yeddyurappa-
led BJP Government
of fraud in the NICE
expressway between
Bangalore and
Mysore. He has shot
off letters to the
Karnataka chief
justice, requesting a
February hearing.
The bench has
asked Gowda to
appear in court in
person or through
an advocate.

by Stephen David